

Smith Bailey, RHP, Arizona

2026 Stats: 4.67 ERA/61.2 IP/1.378 WHIP/65 K/23 BB/2.83 K:BB

6-4, 214

Metrics

FB: 93.9/15.1 IVB/11 HB/-4.8 VAA/6.3 ext/6.06 relH/37.5% zone/40.3 AA/42.9% usage/2290 rpm

CB: 76.6/-9.1 IVB/-11 IVB/-9.48 VAA/35.8% zone/39.3 AA/13.4% usage/2730 rpm

SL: 83.1/1.7 IVB/-4.4 HB/-7.85 VAA/37.8% zone/39.4 AA/30.7% usage/2520 rpm

CH: 83.8/6.4 IVB/16.9 HB/-7.35 VAA/23.1% zone/38.9 AA/13.1% zone/2190 rpm

Write-up

Smith Bailey looks like a starter with big shoulders, long arm behind the back, and tall frame with a high 3/4 arm angle. Across his 30 NCAA starts he's been effective even if his results took a step back in 2026. This was the case of many UofA starters as they lost their pitching coach in the offseason. He looks to rebound as the assumed ace in Tucson for 2027, using his strong four pitch mix to keep Arizona afloat in the Big12 alongside Mason Russell.

The FB is the weakest metric pitch in the arsenal but still profiles as only slightly below average. Bailey has showcased plus ride and plus ASR but the result is an average shape that lacks either and leaks into the deadzone realm. He gets solid carry despite an higher than average release which is the best outcome you can expect from this slot given the raw ride numbers. Commands it well to both halves with whiffs concentrated at the top, generating 24 whiffs to LHH and 14 to RHH up in the zone. The 18.9% whiff rate and 9.9% SWSTR are poor overall but reflect the lack of elite pitch specs. The hope is he can add more velo in 2027 with a bit more muscle and find a more consistent shape. 40/45 pitch CB is slightly below average in velo but is high spin and is late to the zone. Shows very little hump and Bailey has been able to manipulate where he lands the pitch, showcasing the ability to back door to LHH and get D/A to RHH. It has a 40% whiff rate concentrated beneath the zone and its steep VAA despite lackluster raw IVB numbers showcase late bite. 45/45

SL is a firm gyro pitch that plays to more glove side than depth with the high release point. Holds above average spin rate which helps it play better laterally while holding that signature gyro depth. Average tilt is 8:45 and off of that high $\frac{3}{4}$ angle Bailey has, that helps the slider play up. It generated an 18.9% SWSTR through 2026 and a .197 avg while being commanded well to Bailey's glove side. He was not afraid to backfoot to lefties which is a hard thing to do for college arms. Added velo could put this pitch into higher territories. 50/55 pitch

CH is a fader with 2200 spin and good ASR off of FB. The ASR is hard across the zone when arm side and still late when glove side. Despite these good traits, hitters hit .571 against it in 2026 because too many CH were left up in the zone to lefties and righties. On the bright side, it didn't allow a barrel across the year. CH command will be imperative for the pitches development and is holding back its current grade; 23% zone with the zone pitches leaking too far over the plate is a recipe for bad results. 35/45 pitch